

YouTube Downloader – User Guide

This guide explains how to use the YouTube Downloader application. This application is a standalone executable (`.exe`) file, so you don't need to install Python or any other software.

1. Running the Application

1. **Download:** Download the YouTube Downloader `.exe` file.
2. **Run:** Double-click the `.exe` file to launch the application. No installation is required.

2. Using the Application

2.1. Searching for Videos

1. **Enter Search Term:** In the text box at the top, enter either a YouTube video URL or search keywords (e.g., "travel vlog").
2. **Click "Search":** Click the "Search" button (or press Enter).
3. **View Results:** The search results will appear below, showing:
 - Row Number
 - Video Title
 - Video Duration
 - A basic indication of HD availability (if available)
 - Hover over a result to see the full YouTube URL.

2.2. Selecting a Video

1. **Click:** Click on any video in the search results list.
2. **Video Info:** The title and duration will appear below the results.
3. **Quality Options:** The "Video quality" dropdown will be populated with available options.

2.3. Downloading a Video

1. **Quality:** Select your desired video quality from the dropdown.
2. **Audio Only (Optional):** Check "Download audio only" for just the audio (m4a format). This disables the quality selection.
3. **Save Location:**
 - Default: Your "Downloads" folder.
 - Change: Click "Browse..." and choose a folder.

4. **Download:** Click the "Download" button.
5. **Progress Bar:** Shows the download progress.
6. **Status Label:** Displays messages like "Preparing download...", "Downloading...", "Download completed!", or errors.

2.4. Cancelling a Download

1. **Click "Cancel":** During download, click "Cancel" to stop.
2. **Confirmation:** A message confirms cancellation. Incomplete files are removed.

2.5. Dark/Light Mode

1. **Toggle:** Check/uncheck "Dark mode" in the lower-right to switch themes. Your preference is saved.

2.6. Help Menu

1. **User Guide:** Click "Help" -> "User Guide" to open a PDF (user_guide.pdf) with instructions. *The PDF must be in the same folder as the .exe file.*
2. **About:** Click "Help" -> "About" for application information (author, GitHub link, etc.).

3. Settings

Settings (save path, dark mode) are saved in `.yt_downloader_settings.json` in your home directory. Edit this file manually if needed (use correct JSON syntax).

4. Troubleshooting

- **"Help file (user_guide.pdf) not found.":** The `user_guide.pdf` must be in the *same folder* as the `.exe` file.
- **Download Errors:** These can be caused by network problems, video unavailability, or issues with the underlying download library. Check the status label. Try again later or try a different video.
- **Application Freezes:** If the application freezes completely, you may need to force-quit it. If the problem persists, it might be a bug. If you obtained the `.exe` from a trusted source, consider reporting the issue to the developer.

Important Note: This application uses a third-party library (`yt_dlp`) to download videos. YouTube's terms of service may restrict downloading content. Use this application responsibly and respect copyright laws.

Author and Project Information

- **Author:** Long Kelvin
- **Project Name:** yt-downloader
- **GitHub Repository:** <https://github.com/LongKelvin/yt-downloader>
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